Try it at the table

How a Hand Works

Gather your things, then try each one. Guess first. Then look closely and write or draw what you saw.

What you need

- [ ] a mechanical hand toy
- [ ] paper
- [ ] pencil
- [ ] crayon or colored pencil (optional)
- [ ] your own two hands

TRY 1 What keeps a finger stiff?

1. Gently press along one of your fingers and count the hard parts between the bends.
2. Count the stiff pieces on one toy finger too.
3. Do the two numbers match?

I THINK...

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I SAW...

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TRY 2 What pulls a finger closed?

1. Draw around your hand on paper to make an outline.
2. Pull one toy string slowly and watch which finger curls.
3. Draw a line from that string to the same finger on your outline.
4. Do the same for every string, one at a time.

I THINK...

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I SAW...

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TRY 3 Does your hand work like the toy?

1. Curl your pointer finger slowly and count the places it bends.
2. Curl the toy's pointer finger and compare.
3. Rest your other hand on your forearm and wiggle your fingers.
4. What do you feel move?

I THINK…

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I SAW…

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TRY 4 What opens the hand again?

1. Let go of a toy string and watch whether the finger springs back.
2. Look for what pulls it open.
3. Then lay your hand flat, fold your middle finger under, and gently try to lift your ring finger.

I THINK…

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I SAW…

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